

PCB/CCL Update: Estimated Impact from Potential Kyber/Backplane Delay

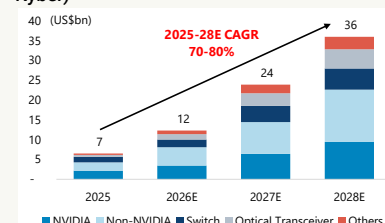
The potential delay of Kyber/backplane PCB for Rubin Ultra may create 5%/8% downside on AI PCB/CCL TAM in 2027 vs our original forecasts and may lead to another 11%/16% downside in 2028 if Kyber is further delayed or canceled. R&D on spec/materials upgrade is ongoing (M9/10/PTFE/CoWoP). -ve for overall PCB supply chain, though we expect upstream to keep outperforming downstream, driven by ongoing near-term price hike, while +ve for copper cable makers.

Potential delay on Kyber/backplane PCB structure due to intra-rack connectivity challenges. Our recent channel checks suggest that, due to the sophistication of orthogonal backplane PCB as a replacement of cable cartridge for intra-rack connectivity, which was originally targeted to be adopted on Rubin Ultra in 2027, Kyber structure will likely to be pushed out to at least 2028. The supply chain began to witness such possibility since May, and in recent few weeks, the absence of Kyber in 2027 has become a highly likely event, which means Rubin Ultra in 2027 will stick to Oberon structure (i.e., NVL72). The supply chain is striving for realizing the Kyber on the new variant of Rubin Ultra in 2028, but the challenges are still outstanding even for 2-canister design within a rack (each canister contains 18 trays) as a simplified solution of original 4-canister, meaning low visibility on crystallization. The worst-case scenario here would be the cancellation of the Kyber in the end.

5%/8% downside for AI PCB/CCL TAM in 2027 vs our original forecasts; Another 11%/16% downside in 2028 if no Kyber eventually. Previously, we estimated AI PCB/CCL TAM (including AI server, high-speed switch and high-speed optical transceiver) at US\$6-7/2-3bn in 2025, and forecast it to reach US\$12/5bn in 2026, US\$25/12bn in 2027, and US\$41/21bn in 2028, driven by both spec (higher-layer and more sophisticated design) and materials (from M8 to M9/10/PTFE) upgrade. If the delay of Kyber/backplane PCB is confirmed, we expect AI PCB/CCL TAM to be reduced by 5%/8% in 2027 compared to our original forecasts. Though the impact seems limited, if it goes beyond 2028 or even gets canceled, we expect a further downside of 11%/16% in 2028. Such change will inevitably bring about less growth upside for the entire PCB supply chain in coming years and negative market sentiment. Despite this, we see the R&D on spec/materials upgrade is still going on, e.g., switch board/midplane may migrate to M9/10/PTFE in 2027, CoWoP is still targeted to penetrate earliest in 2027, etc. Thus, the trend of ongoing dollar content increase on PCB as a core scale-up interconnection solution in AI infrastructure has not seen structural hamper.

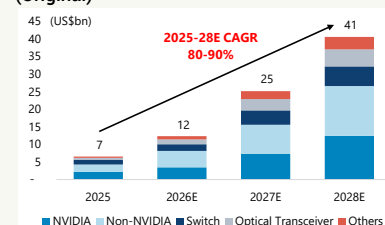
Implication on AI supply chain: -ve for PCB supply chain while upstream may continue to outperform downstream; +ve for copper cable players, thanks to extended lifecycle of Oberon. The potentially lowered TAM may result in certain EPS revision on PCB players, bringing headwinds in stock price performance at any time. But within PCB supply chain, we see ongoing price hike on upstream materials, esp fiberglass cloth and CCL, driven by industrywide supply tightness, and most of those materials vendors are easier to transfer the rising cost and earn extra profits from each price hike compared to PCB makers at this stage. Thus, while it is difficult to predict absolute stock price movement, we think it likely for upstream names to keep outperforming downstream PCB names in near term. On the other hand, the extended adoption of Oberon structure will likely benefit copper cable vendors, in our view, as the threat of being replaced by PCB for intra-rack interconnection could be mitigated, creating more upside for earnings in next few years.

Chart 1 - Global AI PCB TAM Forecast (without Kyber)



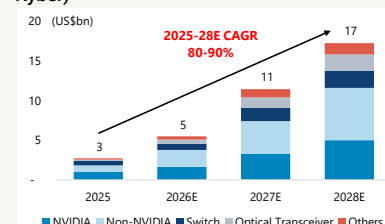
Source: Prismark, Jefferies estimates

Chart 2 - Global AI PCB TAM Forecast (Original)



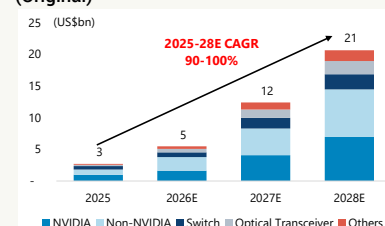
Source: Prismark, Jefferies estimates

Chart 3 - Global AI CCL TAM Forecast (without Kyber)



Source: Prismark, Jefferies estimates

Chart 4 - Global AI CCL TAM Forecast (Original)



Source: Prismark, Jefferies estimates

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NVIDIA Corporation

Price Target: \$300 implies 21x our CY28E EPS of \$14.14.

Risks:

- Emerging competitive threats from INTC, AMD, and internally designed ASICs from Hyperscalers take share and pressure ASPs.
- Slowing datacenter capital spending from Enterprises and Hyperscalers.
- Slower-than-expected ramp of Automotive platform.

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(Article 3(1)e and Article 7 of MAR)

Recommendation Published
Recommendation Distributed

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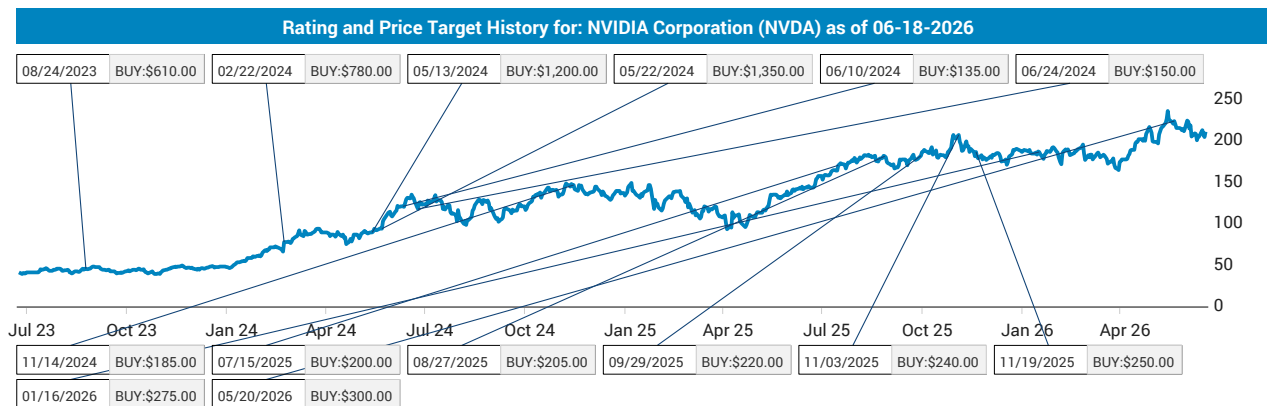
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